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ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION

Central Valley Regional Water Quality Control Board

11 July 2019

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District 3
703 B Street
Marysville, CA 95901

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NOTICE OF APPLICABILITY
GENERAL WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS FOR
SMALL DOMESTIC WASTEWATER TREATMENT SYSTEMS
ORDER WQ 2014-0153-DWQ
FOR
CALIFORNIA DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION
MAXWELL SAFETY ROADSIDE REST AREA
COLUSA COUNTY

The California Department of Transportation (Caltrans) submitted a Report of Waste Discharge (RWD) dated 31 December 2018 for the Maxwell Safety Roadside Rest Area (Maxwell SRRA) in Colusa County. Additional information was submitted on 14 March 2019. Based on the provided information, the wastewater treatment system and discharge are consistent with the requirements of the State Water Resources Control Board (State Water Board) *General Waste Discharge Requirements for Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems*, Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ (General Order). This Notice of Applicability (NOA) provides notice that the General Order is applicable to the site as described below. You are hereby assigned Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ-R5297 for the discharge. A copy of the General Order is enclosed and also available at:

http://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf

You should familiarize yourself with the entire General Order and its attachments, which describe mandatory discharge and monitoring requirements. The General Order contains operational and reporting requirements by wastewater system type. Sampling, monitoring, and reporting requirements applicable to your treatment and disposal methods must be completed in accordance with the appropriate treatment system sections of the General Order and the attached Monitoring and Reporting Program (MRP) 2014-0153-DWQ-R5297. The Discharger is responsible for all the applicable requirements that exist in the General Order and this NOA.

KARL E. LONGLEY SCD, P.E., CHAIR | PATRICK PULUPA, ESQ., EXECUTIVE OFFICER

11020 Sun Center Drive #200, Rancho Cordova, CA 95670 | www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralvalley

REGULATORY BACKGROUND

Waste discharges at the Maxwell SRRA is currently regulated by Waste Discharge Requirements (WDRs) Order 85-321 adopted on 6 December 1985 and Monitoring and Reporting Program (MRP) R5-2013-0806 issued on 15 May 2013. Upon rescission of Order 85-321 at an upcoming Regional Water Board meeting, discharges at the Maxwell SRRA will be regulated under WQ 2014-0153-DWQ-R5297 and MRP 2014-0153-DWQ-R5297.

EXISTING FACILITY AND DISCHARGE DESCRIPTION

Caltrans (hereafter "Discharger") owns and operates the Maxwell SRRA, which is located on Interstate 5, approximately 2.0 miles south of Maxwell at Post Mile 24.30. The Maxwell SRRA has served the northbound (NB) and southbound (SB) traveling public since 1978. Wastewater is generated from the comfort stations (toilet flushing and handwashing) and is pumped to a series of treatment and disposal ponds located at the northbound property. Wastewater enters existing Pond 1, then overflows into Pond 2, 3, and 4. The pond system was originally designed for an ultimate capacity of 33,000 gallons per day (gpd) of raw sewage. Historical data from 2015 to present day show influent flows ranging from 3,000 to 12,600 gpd. Peak flows are generally during the summer months and during the holidays. There are no recreational vehicle (RV) waste disposal facilities at the rest area.

FACILITY CHANGES

The Discharger plans to upgrade the pond system. The ponds will be reconfigured. Pond 1 (previously Pond 3) will be split into two ponds: Pond 1A and 1B. Treatment will occur in Pond 1A, which will be lined with a 60-mil high density polyethylene (HDPE) or equivalent liner and equipped with aerators. From Pond 1A, wastewater will flow by gravity to Ponds 1B, 2, 3, and 4 for final disposal via evaporation and percolation. Pond 1B will be lined with a 60-mil HDPE or equivalent liner on the slopes only. Ponds 2, 3, and 4 will remain as is with cobble lining on the slopes. Additional modifications to the system will include replacing sewer gravity lines with force mains; replacing lift station pumps, valves, sensors and controls, and lining sumps; connecting a Supervisory Control and Data Acquisition (SCADA) system; installing an emergency power generator; and repairing pond access roads along pond berms. The estimated average and peak flow are approximately 7,260 gpd and 15,900 gpd, respectively.

A site plan of the proposed system is shown on Attachment A, which is attached hereto and is made part of this NOA by reference. The proposed pond system is summarized below:

Proposed Pond Name	Existing Pond Name	Depth at 2 feet of Freeboard	Volume (Million gallons)
Pond 1A	Pond 3	5	0.52
Pond 1B	Pond 3	5	1.19
Pond 2	Pond 4	5	1.94
Pond 3	Pond 2	5	1.94
Pond 4	Pond 1	5	1.94

Construction is expected to begin as early as late Summer 2019 with a completion date projected for Winter 2021. The NB and SB rest area will be closed to the public during pond dewatering and construction activities. Any removal of sludge or solids from the ponds during

construction will be disposed of in accordance with the Discharger's Sludge Removal Specification which was included in the RWD.

SITE-SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS AND EFFLUENT LIMITS

The General Order contains prohibitions and specifications that apply to all wastewater treatment systems as well as those that only apply to specific treatment and/or disposal systems. The specific requirements and effluent limits for your treatment system are summarized below.

The wastewater treatment operator must be certified and familiar with the requirements contained in the General Order, this NOA, and the MRP.

Requirements by Wastewater System Type, Section B of General Order

B.1 All Wastewater Systems

This applies in its entirety to the Maxwell SRRA with the following site-specific requirements.

B.1.a Influent flow limit (Section B.1 of General Order)

Treatment Unit	Flow Limit as a Monthly Average
Water Usage ¹	15,900 gallons per day (gpd)
Treatment Pond 1A ²	15,900 gallons per day (gpd)

¹ Until the completion of the new pond system, water usage (exclusive of irrigation water) at the NB and SB rest area shall be monitored.

² In operation once the new pond system is completed.

B.1.I Wastewater system setbacks (Section B.1.I of General Order).

Equipment or Activity	Domestic Well	Flowing Stream	Ephemeral Stream Drainage	Property Line	Lake or Reservoir
Collection System ¹	150 ft.	50 ft.	50 ft.	5 ft.	200 ft.
Ponds ²	150 ft.	150 ft.	150 ft.	30 ft. ³	200 ft.

¹ Setbacks referenced under "Septic Tank, Aerobic Treatment Unit, Treatment System, or Collection System" in Table 3 of General Order. Setbacks apply to the collection system and lift stations.

² Setbacks referenced under "Impoundment (undisinfected secondary recycled water)" in Table 3 of General Order. Setbacks apply to Ponds 1A, 1B, 2, 3, and 4.

³ Setback reduced based on existing location of the ponds.

This is an existing facility, constructed prior to the issuance of the new General Order for Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems, and the ponds may not be compliant with the property line setbacks included in the General Order. However, the facility is permitted under this General Order provided that nuisance conditions do not result from noncompliance.

B.2 Septic Systems – Not Applicable

B.3 Aerobic Treatment Units – Not Applicable

B.4 Activated Sludge Systems – Not Applicable

B.5 Pond Systems

The WWTF utilizes a pond system; therefore Section B.5 of General Order applies in its entirety.

B.6 Subsurface Disposal Systems – Not Applicable

B.7 Land Application and/or Recycled Water Systems – Not Applicable

B.8 Sludge/Solids Disposal

The WWTF consists of lift stations and ponds that may accumulate sludge; therefore Section B.8 of General Order applies in its entirety.

Effluent Limitations, Section D of General Order

This section applies in its entirety to the Maxwell SRRA and shall include the following site-specific limitations.

The following limits apply to effluent from Pond 1A prior to discharge to the evaporation/percolation ponds (i.e., disposal ponds):

Constituent	Units	Limit
BOD	mg/L	90 (monthly average) ¹

¹ The monthly average concentration is the arithmetic mean of measurements recorded during the calendar month. If only one sample is collected in a calendar month, then that sample measurement is the monthly average concentration.

Effluent Limit Rationale

The treatment system is subject to technology performance effluent limits for biochemical oxygen demand (BOD) as specified in the General Order. Based on wastewater quality from several Caltrans rest areas, the typical influent BOD concentration is approximately 470 mg/L. Although a 65-percent reduction of the incoming BOD is approximately 170 mg/L, the proposed treatment is designed to achieve a final effluent BOD concentration of 90 mg/L.

Staff evaluated the need for a total nitrogen effluent limit using the method contained in the General Order and determined that a nitrogen effluent limit is not necessary because the anticipated monthly average and maximum peak flow will be less than 20,000 gpd, treatment Pond 1A will be lined, and all ponds were constructed to maintain a minimum 3.5 feet of separation from shallow groundwater.

Technical Report Preparation Requirements, Provisions Section E.1 of General Order

The following technical reports shall be submitted as described below:

1. **By 1 October 2019**, the Discharger shall submit a *Spill Prevention and Emergency Response Plan* consistent with the requirements of General Order Provision E.1.a.
2. **By 1 October 2019**, the Discharger shall submit a *Sampling and Analysis Plan* consistent with the requirements of General Order Provision E.1.b.

3. **At least 30 days prior** to closure of the NB and SB rest area to the public, the Discharger shall notify the Regional Water Board.
4. **At least 60 days prior** to lining Pond 1A, the Discharger shall submit a *Pond Liner Construction Quality Assurance Plan* that describes the specific construction quality assurance procedures and test methods that will be used to ensure and verify that (a) the liner preparation, installation, and seaming will comply with the specifications; (b) the entire liner is tested following installation to verify that all seams and liner penetrations are leak-free at the time of acceptance; and (c) the entire liner is inspected for visible material defects and construction damage such as holes or tears prior to acceptance.
5. **Within 60 days after** completion of the new onsite wastewater treatment system, the Discharger shall submit a *Wastewater Treatment System Completion Report*. The report shall certify that construction and start-up testing of the new treatment and disposal system have been completed and that the system is fully functional and ready to receive wastewater in compliance with the requirements of the General Order and this NOA. The report shall include final dimensions and liner specifications and a *Liner Construction Quality Assurance (CQA) Report* that documents all construction observation, testing, and test results for the pond lining system and shows that the lining system was leak-free at the time of completion. As-built drawings of the treatment pond and pond liner systems shall be included in the report.

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM

The Discharger shall comply with MRP 2014-0153-DWQ-R5297, which is attached hereto and made part of this NOA by reference.

ENFORCEMENT

Please review this NOA carefully to ensure that it completely and accurately reflects the discharge. Discharge of wastes other than those described in this NOA is prohibited. Prior to allowing changes to the wastewater strength or generation rate, or to the method of waste disposal, you must contact the Central Valley Regional Water Board to determine if submittal of an RWD is required.

Caltrans will generate the waste subject to the terms and conditions of WQ 2014-0153-DWQ-R5297 and will maintain exclusive control over the discharge. As such, Caltrans is primarily responsible for compliance with this NOA, MRP, and General Order, with all attachments. Failure to comply with the requirements in the General Order or this NOA could result in an enforcement action as authorized by provisions of the California Water Code.

ANNUAL FEES

The annual fee is based on the discharge's threat to water quality and complexity rating of 3-C, currently \$2,286. The fee is due and payable on an annual basis until coverage under the General Order is formally rescinded. Please note that the annual fees are reviewed each year and may change. Written notice must be provided from the Discharger if and when the wastewater discharge ceases, so that we can terminate coverage under the General Order and cancel future invoices.

DOCUMENT SUBMITTAL

All monitoring reports and other correspondence should be converted to searchable Portable Document Format (PDF) and submitted electronically. Documents that are less than 50 MB should be emailed to: centralvalleysacramento@waterboards.ca.gov.

To ensure that your submittal is routed to the appropriate staff person, the following information should be included in the body of the email or any documentation submitted to the mailing address for this office:

Facility Name:	Maxwell SRRA, Colusa County
Program:	Non-15 Compliance
Order:	2014-0153-DWQ-R5297
CIWQS Place ID:	239875

Documents that are 50 MB or larger should be copied to a CD, DVD, or flash drive and mailed to:

Central Valley Regional Water Quality Control Board
ECM Mailroom
11020 Sun Center Drive, Suite 200
Rancho Cordova, CA 95670

Now that the Notice of Applicability has been issued, the Board's Compliance and Enforcement section will take over management of your case. Guy Childs is your new point of contact for any questions about compliance with the General Order. If you find it necessary to make a change to your permitted operations, Guy will direct you to the appropriate Permitting staff. You may contact Guy at (916) 464-4648 or at gchilds@waterboards.ca.gov.

for 
PATRICK PULUPA
Executive Officer

Enc: Water Quality Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ
MRP 2014-0153-DWQ-R5297
Attachment A, Site Plan

Cc w/o Enc: Timothy O'Brien, State Water Resources Control Board, Sacramento
Colusa County Environmental Management Department, Woodland
Amar Baidwan, Caltrans, Sacramento
Gerhard Panuschka, Caltrans, Sacramento
Guy Childs, CVRWQCB, Rancho Cordova